him try "Grow Old with Me" on Doubleday. By now, remembering rejections by Merwin, Campbell, and Greenberg, I had grown thoroughly convinced it was an inevitable loser.

"No, Fred," I said, "it stinks."

2 As a side issue, I now weighed 190 pounds, having gained 36 pounds in my 6Vi years of marriage.

"Who cares about your opinion?" said Fred. "Let's see what Doubleday thinks."

So I thought: Well, what harm? I promised I'd get the manuscript over to him sometime.

I made an appointment for March 4 at Johns Hopkins and for March 10 at Boston University. In an effort to make myself look respectable (and remembering the dapper appearance Dawson always had) I bought myself a homburg hat for six dollars. It was the first hat I had owned in many years. How a homburg hat could possibly help me when I was always interviewed indoors and would have to take my hat off the moment I passed the door I can't possibly imagine. As it turned out, I almost never wore the hat and I've never bought another.

On March 4, I took the 6:30 a.m. train to Baltimore, fortified by the knowledge that Al Nason, a Columbia student in the Botany Department, had been interviewed at Johns Hopkins two weeks before and had gotten an offer of $4,200 plus moving expenses. The salary was disappointingly low to me, but he was offered the title of assistant professor.

At Johns Hopkins I met Professor William D. McElroy (who reminded me of Elderfield a bit in appearance and manner). McElroy was as pleasant as could be and told me that the post would be an assistant professorship and would carry $4,500 as a salary. (Nason was not yet a Ph.D., hence the lower offer to him.) It was clear, however that McElroy didn't want me. He admitted that he needed someone with more experience in trace metals than I had, and that he had already accepted as many men as he could take so that he could only make me an offer if someone turned him down—which he didn't think was likely.

I crossed off Johns Hopkins.

There was life in areas outside job hunting. I was turning my dissertation into